06-13 第二篇

Desert Ecosystems

Deserts may seem empty and lifeless, but they are home to a surprising variety of life. Plants, animals, and even people have adapted to survive in these dry, often harsh environments. [1] In other words, deserts are unique ecosystems where living things have developed special ways to cope with little water and extreme temperatures. Understanding how desert life works helps us appreciate the resilience（韧性）of nature and the need to protect these fragile places.

Water is the key to desert survival. [2] Many desert plants have deep roots to reach underground water, or they store water in their stems and leaves. Cacti（仙人掌）can hold large amounts of water and use their spines to reduce water loss and protect themselves. Animals often active only at night to avoid the heat, get most of their water from the food they eat, or can go long periods without drinking. Some creatures even "sleep" through the driest months—a state called estivation（夏眠）—until rain returns.

Desert life is full of surprising adaptations. [3] The camel's hump stores fat, not water, but that fat can be converted into water and energy when needed. Desert foxes have large ears that help them lose heat and hear prey underground. Many desert plants bloom only after a rare rain, producing flowers and seeds in a rush before the land dries again. Each species has found its own way to thrive in conditions that would seem impossible to most living things.

Deserts are under threat. [4] Climate change is making some deserts hotter and drier; others are expanding as farmland turns into wasteland. Overuse of water, mining, and tourism can damage fragile desert soils and disturb wildlife. Conservation efforts—such as protecting desert reserves, limiting water use, and supporting sustainable tourism—are needed to preserve these ecosystems for future generations. What looks empty is actually delicate and worth safeguarding.

[5] Deserts remind us that life can flourish in the most unlikely places. By studying and protecting these ecosystems, we learn not only about the natural world but also about our own responsibility to care for the planet. The next time you think of a desert, remember: it is not empty—it is full of hidden life waiting to be understood and protected.

选项

A. In other words, deserts are distinctive ecosystems where life has adapted to scarce water and extreme conditions. B. That is because both plants and animals have evolved special strategies to save and obtain water. C. In fact, many desert species show

remarkable adaptations—from camels to cacti to rare-blooming plants. D. These threats show that deserts need conservation to survive climate change and human activity. E. In short, deserts are valuable ecosystems that deserve our understanding and protection. F. For example, the Sahara is the largest hot desert in the world.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：引出沙漠作为独特生态系统及其适应特征。空前描述"Deserts may seem empty and lifeless...home to surprising variety of life...Plants, animals, people adapted to survive in dry, harsh environments"，空后说明"deserts are unique ecosystems where living things have developed special ways to cope with little water and extreme temperatures...Understanding helps appreciate resilience...protect fragile places"。A选项"In other words, deserts are distinctive ecosystems where life has adapted to scarce water and extreme conditions"（换言之，沙漠是生命已适应少水与极端条件的独特生态系统）中"In other words"概括空前，"distinctive ecosystems...adapted to scarce water and extreme conditions"与空后"unique ecosystems...special ways to cope with little water and extreme temperatures"精准呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：水是沙漠生存的关键，动植物的节水取水策略。空前提出"Water is the key to desert survival"，空后详述"Plants: deep roots, store water in stems and leaves...Cacti hold water, spines reduce loss...Animals: active at night, get water from food, go long without drinking...estivation through driest months"。B选项"That is because both plants and animals have evolved special strategies to save and obtain water"（那是因为动植物都进化出保存与获取水的特殊策略）中"That is because"解释水为何关键，"strategies to save and obtain water"与空后 deep roots、store water、get from food、estivation 完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：沙漠生物多样化的适应方式举例。空前提出"Desert life is full of surprising adaptations"，空后列举"Camel's hump stores fat...converted to water and energy...Desert foxes large ears...lose heat, hear prey...Plants bloom only after rare rain...Each species found own way to thrive"。C选项"In fact, many desert species show remarkable adaptations—from camels to cacti to rare-blooming plants"（事实上，许多沙漠物种展现出非凡的适应——从骆驼到仙人掌到罕见开花

的植物）中"In fact"强化适应多样性，"camels...cacti...rare-blooming plants"与空后 camel、desert foxes、plants bloom after rain 精准对应，衔接自然。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：沙漠面临的威胁及保护必要。空前提出"Deserts are under threat"，空后描述"Climate change making some hotter and drier...others expanding...Overuse of water, mining, tourism damage soils and disturb wildlife...Conservation efforts: protect reserves, limit water use, sustainable tourism...preserve for future...delicate and worth safeguarding"。D选项"These threats show that deserts need conservation to survive climate change and human activity"（这些威胁表明沙漠需要保护才能应对气候变化与人类活动）中"These threats"指代空后气候、用水、采矿、旅游等，"conservation to survive"与空后"conservation efforts...preserve"完美对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与沙漠生态价值及保护呼吁。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"Deserts remind us life can flourish in unlikely places...studying and protecting...learn about natural world and responsibility...not empty—full of hidden life...understood and protected"。E选项"In short, deserts are valuable ecosystems that deserve our understanding and protection"（简言之，沙漠是值得我们理解与保护的宝贵生态系统）用"In short"总结全文，"valuable ecosystems...understanding and protection"与空后"study and protect...understood and protected"形成呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the Sahara is the largest hot desert in the world.**：涉及撒哈拉沙漠为最大热沙漠，易被误填[1]或[3]。但F以"For example"引出单一沙漠案例，而空[1]讨论的是沙漠生态系统的普遍特征，F的"Sahara...largest"属于地理事实，与"unique ecosystems...adapted to conditions"的功能论述焦点不同；空[3]讨论物种适应案例，F的"Sahara"为地名，与 camel、cacti、plants 等生物适应无直接关联。F属"主题相关但论述角度错位"型干扰。